

Mizoram is India's first fully literate state

In an age of **widening social inequities**, a quiet revolution has **unfolded** in the country's Northeast. Mizoram has become India's first fully literate state under the Centre's **ULLAS** — New India Literacy Programme. According to the latest data from the Periodic Labour Force Survey, **98.2 per cent** of Mizo citizens aged seven and above **are** now literate — well above the national average of 80.9 per cent, and ahead even of Kerala, long **celebrated** for its human development achievements.

The story behind Mizoram's achievement is not one of **top-down technocracy** alone. It speaks of a broader, more **holistic** model of **inclusive** development that involves patient, community-led work or what Mizos recognise as tlawmngaihna. It is a story of **volunteers** who **braved remote** locations and poor connectivity to **bring** literacy **to the last mile**, and of individuals who aspired to be more. The result is success in an area where India has long struggled: Adult and functional literacy. Rural literacy in Mizoram stands at 98.1 per cent, while urban areas reach 98.3 per cent, indicating almost no urban-rural divide, an **anomaly** in a country where the gap **often** exceeds 15 percentage points. Mizoram ranks high on other important indicators as well. It **boasts** the third-highest female workforce participation rate in the country. **Its sex ratio** at birth (975 females per 1,000 males) **surpasses** the national average (929). It has the lowest **infant mortality rate** in the Northeast, and one of India's highest school attendance rates at both primary and secondary levels.

While size is a defining factor, in India, where development is often **equated** with urban growth, there is a lesson here for larger and more **resource-rich** states. Mizoram shows that policy **nimbleness** is often a function of intent and **accountability**, that investing in people, trusting local institutions, and building with community at the centre can **move mountains**. As India looks to a digital, green and global future, the path ahead must concern itself with the **dignity** and agency of all, including and especially those **on the margins**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Move mountains** (phrase) – achieve spectacular and apparently impossible results.

Vocabulary

1. **Widening** (adjective) – Expanding, broadening, increasing, growing, enlarging
बढ़ता हुआ
2. **Social inequity** (noun) – refers to the unequal distribution of resources, opportunities, and privileges among different groups within a society सामाजिक असमानता
3. **Unfold** (verb) – Develop, emerge, reveal, happen, come to light प्रकट होना
4. **ULLAS** (noun) – Acronym for *Understanding Lifelong Learning for All in Society*; used here as the name of the literacy programme. The scheme aims to provide educational opportunities to adults aged 15 and above who have missed out on formal schooling, focusing on foundational literacy and numeracy, critical life skills, vocational skills, and continuing education.
5. **Celebrated** (adjective) – Famous, renowned, acclaimed, lauded, well-known प्रसिद्ध
6. **Top-down** (adjective) – Hierarchical, centralized, controlled-from-above, directive, authoritarian उपर से नीचे
7. **Technocracy** (noun) – Rule by experts, technocratic system, governance by specialists, technical administration विशेषज्ञों द्वारा शासन
8. **Holistic** (adjective) – Comprehensive, integrated, complete, overall, all-encompassing समग्र
9. **Inclusive** (adjective) – All-embracing, open, comprehensive, accepting, all-encompassing समावेशी
10. **Volunteer** (noun) – Helper, contributor, participant, unpaid worker, aid worker स्वयंसेवक
11. **Brave** (verb) – Face, confront, endure, defy, dare सामना करना
12. **Remote** (adjective) – Distant, far-off, isolated, secluded, faraway दूरस्थ
13. **Bring something to the last mile** (phrase) – Deliver fully, reach the end-user, complete implementation, ensure access, finish the delivery अंतिम व्यक्ति तक पहुंचाना
14. **Anomaly** (noun) – Exception, irregularity, aberration, oddity, deviation विसंगति
15. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, many times अक्सर
16. **Boast** (verb) – Flaunt, claim proudly, show off, brag, display गर्व से कहना
17. **Surpass** (verb) – Exceed, outdo, beat, outshine, overtake पार करना

18. **Infant mortality rate** (noun) – the number of deaths of infants under one year old per 1,000 live births शिशु मृत्यु दर

19. **Equate** (with) (verb) – Associate, compare, liken, connect, match समान मानना

20. **Resource-rich** (adjective) – Wealthy (in resources), resourceful, abundant, well-endowed, asset-rich संसाधन संपन्न

21. **Nimbleness** (noun) – Agility, quickness, flexibility, adaptability, responsiveness फुर्ती/तेजी

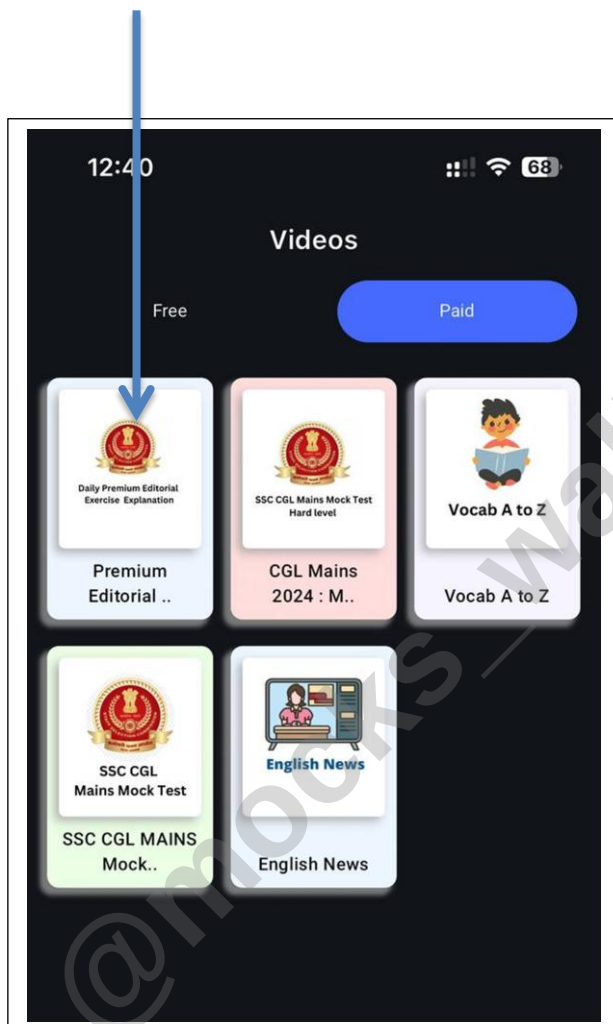
22. **Accountability** (noun) – Responsibility, answerability, liability, obligation, transparency जवाबदेही

23. **Dignity** (noun) – Respect, honor, self-worth, prestige, decency गरिमा

24. **On the margins** (phrase) – At the edge, marginalized, disadvantaged, excluded, neglected समाज के किनारे पर/हाशिये पर

@mocks_wallah

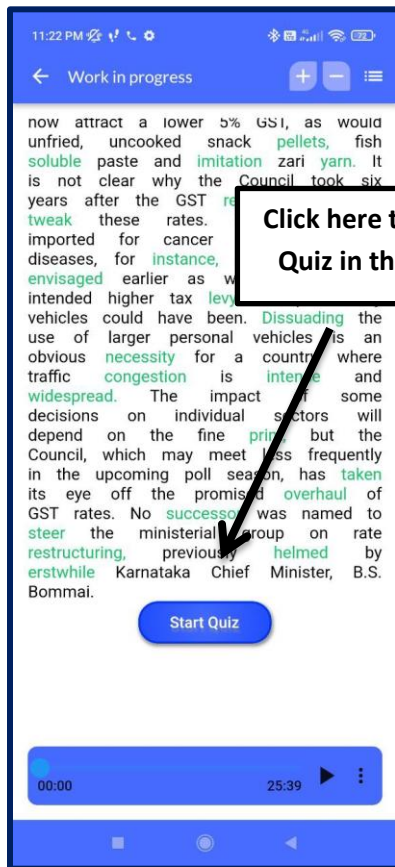
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



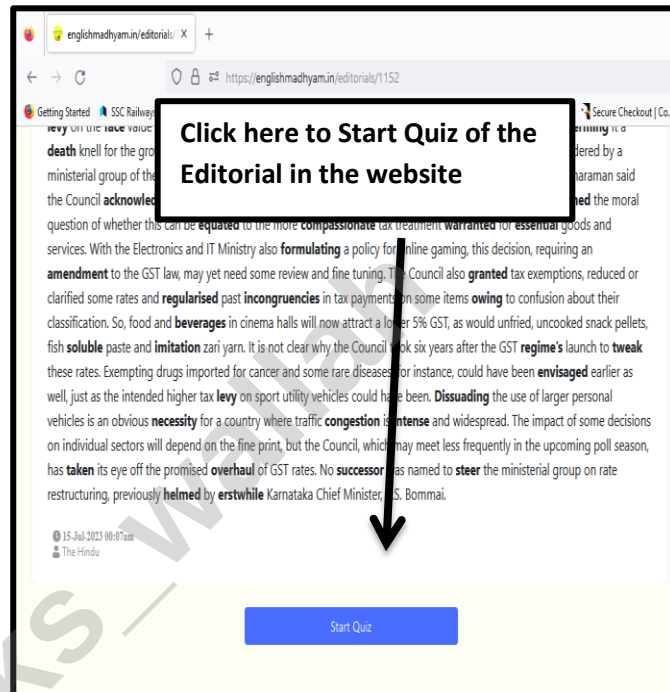
Summary of the Editorial

1. Mizoram has become India's first fully literate state under the Centre's ULLAS — New India Literacy Programme.
2. The Periodic Labour Force Survey shows 98.2% literacy among Mizo citizens aged seven and above.
3. This literacy rate far exceeds the national average of 80.9% and even surpasses Kerala's renowned literacy levels.
4. Mizoram's success story is rooted in community-driven efforts, not just top-down policies.
5. A cultural ethic called *tlawmngaihna* inspired patient, volunteer-led work across difficult terrains.
6. Volunteers reached remote and poorly connected areas to ensure literacy extended to the last mile.
7. Mizoram achieved remarkable progress in adult and functional literacy, an area of persistent national struggle.
8. Rural literacy in Mizoram is at 98.1%, while urban literacy stands at 98.3%.
9. The negligible urban-rural literacy gap contrasts sharply with India's typical gap of over 15 percentage points.
10. Mizoram also ranks high in female workforce participation, holding the third-highest rate nationally.
11. The state's sex ratio at birth is 975 females per 1,000 males, well above the national average of 929.
12. Mizoram has the lowest infant mortality rate among Northeastern states.
13. It also boasts one of India's highest school attendance rates at both primary and secondary levels.
14. The state's achievement underscores that effective policies rely on intent, accountability, and empowering local communities.
15. Mizoram's example offers lessons to larger and richer states on prioritizing human development over mere urban-centric growth, ensuring dignity and agency for all, especially marginalized populations.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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